



1-24-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z5O1zUiv560
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Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 17, 2023

Report By: Expert Civic Analyst

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees was called to order at **00:01:21** by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Dr. Bales, Watashi Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Jim Lowe.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Heater (out of the country).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Jim Lowe (implied by call to order/chairing duties).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The meeting opened with a moment of silence honoring recently deceased Muncie Central graduate John Bragg (Class of '70/'71), followed by the recitation of the

Pledge of Allegiance 00:01:24.

- January was recognized as School Board Appreciation Month, featuring blue appreciation bags and refreshments provided by Chartwells 00:22:12.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes from January 10th were approved as part of the consent agenda 00:27:33.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:31 Presentation: English Learners (EL) & Multilingual Programs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chelsea, EL Program Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Detailed definitions for EI status, multilingual, newcomer (in U.S. < 3 years), and English as a New Language (ENL).
 - Highlighted massive growth in enrollment: EI status students grew from 84 in October 2021 to 126 in October 2022, and reached 180 students by January 2023 (a 114% increase over 15 months).
 - Noted shifting demographics: Top newcomer countries include Afghanistan, Nigeria, and India. Highlighted “second wave” migration where families originally placed elsewhere by the U.S. government moved to Muncie by word-of-mouth.
 - Outlined programmatic offerings, including a new ENL secondary curriculum, drop-in academic resource support, a dedicated full-time EI teacher at Northview Elementary (highest EI population), and a K-5 Spanish Dual Language Immersion program (with planning underway for middle school at Northside).
 - Introduced Indiana’s new Certificate of Multilingual Proficiency (replacing Seal of Biliteracy) for graduating seniors.
 - Noted high school newcomer student participation and certification success in the Muncie Career Center (Max Center) Fire and Rescue program, a summer intensive English grant program via Ideo, and ongoing partnerships with Ball State University’s TESOL and Spanish departments.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote required.
- **00:28:49 Resolution / Agreement: Delaware Blackford Special Education Cooperative Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Smithson, Director / Superintendent’s Council representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Reviewed updates to the multi-district special education cooperative agreement across the seven participating school districts.

- Highlighted adjustments on page 5 (highlighted in red) regarding shared versus non-shared costs. Specific evaluation costs, behavior specialist services, and occupational/physical therapy (OT/PT) were removed from shared district costs to reflect fair, individualized services rendered via IEPs, leaving blind/low-voltage and deaf/hard-of-hearing teachers as shared district costs.
 - Noted that legal counsel David Day and attorney Mr. Jerome reviewed the agreement, and the co-op recently passed an audit with no findings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:36:02](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:26:09](#) **Chelsea Pendergraft**
 - **Topic:** Special education student care and safety at Grissom Elementary.
 - **Summary:** Expressed concern as a parent of a special needs kindergarten student at Grissom Elementary. Called for the immediate termination of staff member Brittany Charles due to alleged neglect and abuse allegations currently under investigation by the Muncie Police Department. Criticized Grissom Elementary for failing to document IEP protocols, under-reporting incidents to parents, denying a one-on-one aide request on November 28th based on budgeting/principal discretion, and suggesting the family transfer schools.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Superintendent Report (Dr. Krakowski) [00:22:26](#):**
 - Southside Middle School qualified one team for the state robotics finals (expanding to 6 teams this year).
 - Security checks implemented by Robert Scafes are proceeding successfully.
 - Weather monitoring is underway regarding impending winter weather; e-learning schedules and devices were sent home, with a final determination expected early the following morning.
 - The Muncie Career Center (The MAC) was ranked #13 in the Indianapolis Business Journal as one of the largest tech and vocational education programs in Indiana.
 - Highlighted athletic achievements: Titus water (wrestling heavyweight, undefeated 37-0, conference champ, ranked #6 in state) and Isaac Musgrove (126 lbs, conference champ).
 - **Board Member Announcements [00:37:50](#):**

- Watashi Barnes Griffin thanked MCS for participating in the Martin Luther King Jr. Day events, distributing 120 student citizenship certificates, and noted upcoming Black History Month programming in February, including a musical program at Northside Middle School directed by Ben Williams, and a 100 push-up club demonstration.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [00:39:43](#).
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